

Dipesh Bhattarai

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Western Kentucky University, Gordon Ford College of Business

August 2024 - Present

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Finance, University of Tennessee

May 2024

M.B.A, Mississippi State University

May 2018

B.B.A in Banking and Finance, Pokhara University

May 2016

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Corporate Governance, Shareholder Activism, Board of Directors, Machine Learning, Large Language Models

WORKING PAPERS

The Effect of Director Wealth on Corporate Governance and Firm Value

- 2024: Southwestern Finance Association, Research Symposium on Finance and Economics, Financial Management Association, Southern Finance Association
- 2023: Financial Management Association Doctoral Consortium, Neel Corporate Governance Research Forum

When Does Shareholder Communication Matter? Evidence from Proxy Exempt Solicitations

with Brian Blank, Kathryn M. Schumann, Tingting Liu, & Tracie Woidtke

- 2023: Weinberg Center & ECGI Corporate Governance Symposium* - *Best Paper Finalist*, The Financial Intermediation Research Society (FIRS)*
- 2022: Financial Management Association (FMA), SEC Seminar*, Neel Corporate Governance Seminar*, Mississippi State University*

Portable Director-Specific Quality

with Roy Schmardebeck, Matthew Serfling & Tracie Woidtke

- 2023: Eastern Finance Association (EFA), Drexel Corporate Governance Conference
- 2022: Financial Management Association (FMA), Southern Finance Association (SFA), Financial Markets and Corporate Governance Conference (FMCg), Neel Corporate Governance Seminar, Washington State University*, Kent State University*, University of Kansas*

OTHER CONFERENCE PARTICIPATION

Discussant

- 2024: Southwestern Finance Association, Research Symposium on Finance and Economics
- 2023: Eastern Finance Association (EFA)
- 2022: Financial Management Association Annual Meeting, Southern Financial Association Annual Meeting, Financial Market and Corporate Governance Annual Meeting

Session Chair

- 2023: Eastern Finance Association (EFA)
- 2022: Southern Financial Association

*Presentation by co-author

MEDIA MENTIONS

[Do Individual Directors Matter?](#), *Columbia Law School Blue Sky Blog*, November 17, 2022.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Primary Instructor

- Securities and Portfolio Management (FIN 439), Spring 2026 (Eval: 4.7/5.0)
- Investment Theory (FIN 332), Spring 2026 (Eval: 4.8/5.0)
- Investment Theory (FIN 332), Fall 2025 (Eval: 4.8/5.0)
- Principles of Finance (FIN 330), Fall 2025 (Eval: 4.9/5.0)
- Investment Theory (FIN 332), Spring 2025 (Eval: 4.8/5.0)
- Principles of Finance (FIN 330), Spring 2025 (Eval: 4.9/5.0)
- Investment Theory (FIN 332), Fall 2024 (Eval: 4.8/5.0)
- Principles of Finance (FIN 330), Fall 2024 (Eval: 4.9/5.0)
- International Finance (IB 449 Section 1), Spring 2023 (Eval: 4.7/5.0)
- International Finance (IB 449 Section 1), Spring 2022 (Eval: 4.8/5.0)

Teaching Assistant

- Financial Management: Theory and Practice (FINC 455), Fall 2023
- Advanced Financial Management (FINC 457-555), Fall 2022
- International Finance (IB 449), Fall 2021

SERVICE EXPERIENCE

- GFCB Artificial Intelligence Committee, Current- Spring 2026
- Gordon Ford College of Business Research Committee, Current-Fall 2024

SKILLS & PROJECTS

Programming Language Skills

Python || SAS || Stata || R || Excel VBA || JavaScript

Projects

- GFCB AI HUB: Developed a centralized website that enables faculty to use large language models (LLMs) to support research, teaching, and other academic activities.
- ChatSEC: Developed a program that utilizes advanced Large Language Models (LLMs) to provide answers to any question regarding a company's filings made to the Securities Exchange Commission.
- CEO-PAY-RATIO: Designed a program using GPT models (OpenAI), BERT (Huggingface), and WRDS to retrieve pay ratio disclosures.
- SECGPT: Created SECGPT, an open source Large Language Model for the financial domain, by finetuning Falcon-7B with SEC filings for text completion and question answering task. (Available in Huggingface's model hub)
- Crypto Attention Tracker: Created a Python script that analyzes Google Trends data to identify popular crypto currencies.
- Google Scholar Scraper: Constructed a program capable of extracting various data elements from Google Scholar, including title, authors, year, journal, and citations, for a given keyword.
- Engineered a Python script that employs image processing techniques to extract tabular data from PDF or image files.